

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Microsoft Sentinel / Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) and senior cyber security engineer with over five years of experience specialising in Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), detection engineering, and security operations. I have built and maintain enterprise-scale Microsoft Sentinel deployments, developing custom analytics rules in Kusto Query Language (KQL), deploying data connectors and log sources, and building detection and response workflows aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework. At the University of the Arts London (UAL), I engineer and manage a Microsoft Sentinel SIEM environment integrated with CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, achieving comprehensive security telemetry coverage across identity, endpoint, cloud, and network layers. I automate security workflows using PowerShell scripting and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks, and I partner with incident response teams to investigate live threats, tuning detection rules against real-world attack activity. I am now seeking a senior SIEM engineering role within a leading Microsoft security partner organisation where I can drive enterprise-scale Sentinel deployments, advance SIEM content development, and contribute to cutting-edge threat detection and response capabilities.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel:** enterprise-scale deployment, log onboarding, standard and custom data connectors, Function Apps, analytics rules, workbooks, watchlists, SOAR integration
- **Kusto Query Language (KQL):** advanced threat hunting queries, custom analytics rules, detection content development, scheduled and near-real-time rule creation
- **SIEM Content Development:** detection rule creation and tuning, false positive reduction, analytics rule lifecycle management, MITRE ATT&CK aligned coverage
- **Security Telemetry:** identity logs (Entra ID, Active Directory), endpoint telemetry (CrowdStrike, MDE), cloud logs (Azure), network telemetry, email security (Mimecast)
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Logic Apps, PowerShell playbooks, automated alert triage and response
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Extended Detection and Response (XDR)
- **CrowdStrike Falcon:** NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover, Falcon telemetry integration with SIEM
- **Threat Hunting:** proactive investigation across endpoint, identity, cloud, and network telemetry
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 framework, MITRE ATT&CK threat model
- **Scripting:** PowerShell (automation, SOAR playbooks, API integration)
- **Identity Security:** Microsoft Entra ID, Azure Active Directory (AD), Conditional Access, MFA, SSO
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentra BAS, Nessus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

University of the Arts London (UAL)

- Own and optimise enterprise-wide log onboarding into Microsoft Sentinel, deploying standard data connectors alongside custom connectors and Function Apps to integrate telemetry from CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Mimecast, and network infrastructure
- Develop and maintain custom Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules and scheduled hunting queries in Microsoft Sentinel, building tailored SIEM detection content aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework and driving real-world threat detection and response

- Build and optimise Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation playbooks using PowerShell and Microsoft Logic Apps, reducing manual alert triage effort and accelerating incident response workflows
- Partner with the incident response team on live investigations, tuning detection rules and analytics against active threat actor activity and incorporating lessons learned to improve detection fidelity
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, and Discover modules across an estate of 8,000+ users, integrating CrowdStrike telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel for unified SIEM visibility
- Administer Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender as part of an integrated Extended Detection and Response (XDR) architecture, correlating signals across identity, endpoint, and cloud sources
- Conduct proactive threat hunting across endpoint, identity, cloud, and network telemetry using KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying indicators of compromise before alerts are triggered
- Configure and manage Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and Single Sign-On (SSO) policies, integrating identity telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel for identity threat detection
- Lead vulnerability management using Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentra BAS, and Nessus, integrating vulnerability findings into SIEM for consolidated risk visibility
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and manage Check Point Harmony firewall rules, onboarding PAM and firewall logs into Sentinel for privilege abuse and network threat detection

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

University of the Arts London (UAL)

- Developed and maintained KQL detection rules and threat hunting queries in Microsoft Sentinel, identifying attack patterns aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework and reducing mean time to detect (MTTD)
- Managed and optimised CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and EDR deployments, investigating alerts and tuning detection rules to reduce false positives and improve signal quality
- Conducted structured threat hunting exercises across endpoint, identity, and network telemetry in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, proactively identifying indicators of compromise
- Supported Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) deployment, onboarding devices, configuring detection policies, and integrating telemetry into the SIEM
- Collaborated with IT and infrastructure teams to onboard new log sources into Microsoft Sentinel, expanding SIEM coverage and improving detection rule effectiveness
- Performed SIEM content development and analytics rule tuning to improve detection accuracy and reduce alert fatigue across the security operations function
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure AD), configuring Conditional Access policies and monitoring identity threat signals within Microsoft Sentinel
- Conducted incident response investigations using SIEM telemetry, documenting findings and implementing containment and eradication actions
- Operated Mimecast email security and integrated email threat telemetry into the SIEM for phishing and business email compromise detection

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

- Implemented and maintained security controls across the SaaS and FinTech infrastructure, including endpoint security, network monitoring, and access controls
- Conducted security quality assurance activities including vulnerability assessments and security configuration reviews within a cloud-native environment
- Supported IT infrastructure provisioning, maintenance, and troubleshooting, building a strong foundation in security engineering and log analysis
- Contributed to security policy development and technical documentation, supporting the organisation's compliance and governance objectives

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and maintained enterprise-scale Microsoft Sentinel SIEM deployment, onboarding security telemetry from CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Defender suite, Mimecast, and network sources to achieve comprehensive visibility across identity, endpoint, cloud, and network layers for 8,000+ users
- Developed a library of custom Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, improving threat detection accuracy and enabling proactive threat hunting across the enterprise
- Built SOAR automation playbooks using PowerShell and Microsoft Logic Apps, accelerating incident triage, reducing manual analyst workload, and improving consistency of incident response workflows
- Led Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) deployment across 8,000+ users, establishing comprehensive EDR and identity threat detection coverage integrated with the Microsoft Sentinel SIEM
- Configured Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA policies, integrating identity telemetry into Sentinel to enable real-time detection of identity-based threats across the enterprise
- Maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification compliance, ensuring ongoing alignment with National Cyber Security Centre (NCSC) security requirements

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)